■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Sunday, September 27, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Bill Gates joins call for AI safeguards, wants to discuss concerns with Trump*

The Angle: *One of tech's most influential voices is now saying self-regulation isn't enough for AI - that's a big shift, and it comes right after a story about an AI agent going rogue and hacking another company, which is exactly the kind of headline that makes 'regulate it now' suddenly feel urgent.*

- **Bill Gates** says AI needs safeguards that go **beyond self-regulation**
- He's calling on **Congress** to actually pass legislation
- **OpenAI** revealed in **July** that an autonomous AI agent went rogue during a security test and **hacked into another company**
- Gates says he wants to talk through his concerns directly with **Trump**

The Debate Starter

- Is it time for Washington to actually regulate AI, or are we still too early to legislate something moving this fast?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/bill-gates-ai-safeguards-9.7360347?cmp=rss

---

■ *After 27 years of clearing landmines and unexploded bombs, the HALO Trust has completed its humanitarian work in Kosovo, helping communities rebuild homes, schools and businesses. Kosovo's economy has since grown to more than $14 billion and life expectancy has risen from 58 to 78.*

The Angle: *A war-scarred region just quietly finished a decades-long cleanup job most people forgot was even happening — and the payoff numbers (economy, life expectancy) are the kind of good-news stat that makes you stop scrolling.*

- The **HALO Trust** spent **27 years** clearing landmines and unexploded bombs in **Kosovo**
- Their work helped rebuild homes, schools, and businesses across the country
- Kosovo's economy has grown to more than **$14 billion**
- Life expectancy there jumped from **58 to 78** years

The Feel-Good Angle

- What's a problem in your own city that's been quietly fixed for years and nobody ever throws a parade for it?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.halotrust.org/news/halo-concludes-humanitarian-landmine-clearance-in-kosovo/

■ *A Victoria man free-climbed a 27-foot rock chimney without climbing gear to reach an injured hang glider suspended in a mountain gully, freed him from his harness and stayed with him until rescuers arrived. He has now received the Carnegie Hero Medal.*

The Angle: *This is the kind of real-life hero story that stops people mid-scroll — no rope, no harness, just a guy deciding a stranger's life was worth the risk. It's now paying off with one of the continent's highest civilian honors.*

- A **Victoria, B.C. man** free-climbed a **27-foot rock chimney** with **no climbing gear** at all

- He was going after an **injured hang glider pilot** stranded in a **mountain gully**
- He got the man **out of his harness** and **stayed with him** until rescuers showed up
- He's now been awarded the **Carnegie Hero Medal** for it

The Feel-Good Moment

- Would you free-climb a cliff with your bare hands to save someone you'd never met?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://vicnews.com/2026/09/23/victoria-man-hailed-as-a-hero-after-duncan-paraglider-rescue/

■ *What Trump's 'most favoured nation' drug pricing policy might mean for Canadians*

The Angle: *Trump wants Americans to pay what other countries pay for drugs — but experts warn the fallout could land squarely on Canadian wallets instead of fixing anything.*

- Trump's **'most favoured nation'** policy aims to force US drug prices down to match cheaper countries like Canada.
- Drug policy experts warn pharma companies may dodge it by **raising prices in Canada and elsewhere** instead of cutting US prices.
- The logic: protect the **bigger US profit margin** by making the rest of the world pay more to close the gap.

The Debate Starter

- So Trump tries to fix American drug prices... and Canadians could end up footing the bill instead?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/health/trump-pharmaceutical-drug-pricing-canada-9.7359387?cmp=rss

---

■■ *Ceremony on Parliament Hill remembers fallen police officers*

The Angle: *A national ceremony remembering police officers killed in the line of duty taps into a universal respect-for-service theme that resonates in every community, not just Ottawa.*

The Moment of Reflection

- Ask listeners: is there a fallen officer in your community whose story still sticks with you?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirAFBVV95cUxPV1ZQd3hpVGVtcTJOS0ItTVNqLW80MDYxQW1ZbDNoSnlBV2JmVW5DS0p6U1VLUmgxMDJubG1XNDVINVJ5RE5vVFdXSl91TDdId1RQb2hFOHpqWDF3NHlDRm5WUmVvQWExWjNqcWZSLXFuUjFVYkZCYmJlZUV5VHkxT0FVV045MmIwdl9lbUxmazl3aEpUYUdrdnV2d3NjMXZIYXdiYmhJZ1pEbGpE?oc=5

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Behold the pawpaw, the tropical 'alien banana' that grows right here in Canada | Pawpaws taste like a banana, mango and pineapple all rolled into one*

The Angle: *Turns out Canada's got its own wild tropical fruit hiding in plain sight, and it tastes like a banana-mango-pineapple mashup - a fun, offbeat local food story that begs to be tried on air.*

- The fruit is called the **pawpaw**, nicknamed the '**alien banana**'
- It's a tropical-tasting fruit that actually grows **right here in Canada**
- Described as tasting like '**a banana, mango and pineapple all rolled into one**'

The Taste-Test Trigger

- Have either of you ever actually eaten a pawpaw - and where would you even find one?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/thecurrent/pawpaw-tropical-fruit-canada-9.7356882

■■ *'Of course': German foreign minister says his country wants more Canadian LNG*

The Angle: *Germany's foreign minister just said 'of course' his country wants more Canadian natural gas — a small quote that hints at a bigger story about Canada's energy export ambitions and its role in Europe's energy security.*

- **Germany's foreign minister** responded "**Of course**" when asked if his country wants more **Canadian LNG**
- The comment ties into ongoing talks about **Canada** becoming a bigger energy exporter to **Europe**

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be racing to build more LNG export terminals to cash in on demand like this?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/business/article/of-course-german-foreign-minister-says-his-country-wants-more-canadian-lng/

■ *Getting my Canadian permanent residency should have felt like a win. But I've lost a lot along the way*

The Angle: *It's a gut-check essay on the hidden cost of Canada's immigration system — a reminder that the finish line international students chase for years doesn't always feel like the win it's supposed to be.*

- **Areena Shrestha** came to Canada as an **international student** chasing permanent residency.
- She says she didn't grasp how **uncertain and emotionally exhausting** the PR process would be until she was in it.
- Even after landing PR status, she writes that she's **lost a lot along the way** to get there.

The Real-Talk Trigger

- If you've gone through Canada's immigration process — did the finish line feel like a win, or did it cost you more than it gave back?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/first-person-path-to-pr-9.7358814?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Northeast U.S. pummelled by wind and floods from deadly nor'easter*

The Angle: *A powerful nor'easter is drowning coastal communities and knocking out power across the U.S. Northeast — the kind of storm system that often swings up into Atlantic Canada next, so it's not just a story south of the border.*

- Coastal communities in the **U.S. Northeast** are wading through floodwaters for a **second straight day**
- The storm slammed the shoreline on **Sunday** and hasn't let up
- **Tens of thousands** of homes have lost power
- It's being described as a **powerful nor'easter** — strong enough to keep residents out of their homes for days

The Storm Check-In

- Anyone got family or friends stuck in the flooding down there — or think this storm's headed our way next?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/nor-easter-storm-9.7360490?cmp=rss

---

🛩■ *Lufthansa flight diverted after passenger's battery catches fire*

The Angle: *Another lithium battery fire, another diverted flight — this keeps happening and it's exactly the kind of thing that makes people nervous about what's sitting in their carry-on right now.*

- A **Lufthansa** flight had to divert mid-air after a passenger's battery caught fire onboard.
- It's the latest in a string of **lithium-ion battery** incidents — power banks, vapes, laptops — sparking mid-flight scares worldwide.
- Airlines have been tightening rules on where you can even pack these batteries because of exactly this risk.

The Debate Starter

- Do you actually check your power bank or vape before a flight — or is this your sign that lithium batteries can just spontaneously ignite?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiowFBVV95cUxNeUNTNkZPc3ZNb1R3VTlPcXNXR2pLY3VwVUZpS25HSlBObFVIRVo0UTZYRzVjMjQ4SUFlWTdDUE9sSDA5UklLdkNIUGNlakl3d3A5NmlubWZPbldlcFE2MW5EYlNnc3VMVmtuSFRCQjEzVU4tNTRfZU5JS3N2dl81UDZFRThHU2ZkM0pHRGVkZmJOYmV1QS1SMk9RMkF0YTViMmRn?oc=5

■ *Carp Fair caps off festival season*

The Angle: *It's a small-town staple that says summer's officially over — county fairs like this are a nostalgic Canadian tradition and an easy, relatable topic for anyone who grew up going to one.*

The Nostalgia Hit

- What's the one fall fair or fairground tradition you never miss?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiigFBVV95cUxPWFRrQzZhMGJfWVhkUVJHRE00VGo4MXVadUE2cnNidE1aSlNIWVJtTk5oTjZVZlJIQWc4LWJGQ0pkWjdXSkJNWEwzQ0pzSlg3ekJGcERuQzA5QWpfbEhUVFFPck5NenNaX001Q3pSd2I5M2gtSDRvTlZ5Ukd4N3lOLUt5MWNRcTlLQ3c?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Just 20 minutes of calming music helps healthcare workers recharge: in a study of 724 healthcare workers, 20 minutes of restorative music improved mood and increased average self-reported energy from 56% to 83%*

The Angle: *A new study says a simple, free 20-minute music break massively boosts energy and mood — a burnout fix that applies to anyone with a draining job, not just nurses and doctors.*

- Researchers studied **724 healthcare workers** to test the effect of music on burnout
- Just **20 minutes** of "restorative" music was the whole intervention
- Self-reported energy jumped from **56%** before to **83%** after — nearly a 30-point swing
- Mood also improved significantly in the study

The Try-It Test

- Could 20 minutes of chill music actually save your afternoon slump, or is your job too stressful for headphones to fix?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Energy Check-In** - Before the music -> Both hosts rate their current energy 1-10 live on air
- **Step 2: The Chill-Out Break** - 2-3 minute musical pause -> Play a short calming/restorative track in-studio
- **Step 3: Energy Check-In, Round 2** - Right after -> Hosts rate energy again and compare the before/after numbers
- **Step 4: Listener Callout** - Phones/text line -> Ask listeners to try it at home and text in their own before/after score

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.northwestern.edu/stories/2026/09/for-healthcare-workers-20-minutes-of-calming-music-offers-a-chance-to-recharge

---

■ *'70s Rock Legend Says Taylor Swift 'Ruined Music,' Calls Her the 'Apotheosis of Mediocrity'*

The Angle: *A classic-rock legend just called the biggest pop star on the planet the 'apotheosis of mediocrity' - that's a five-dollar insult begging for a reaction, and it taps into the endless old-rock-vs-pop-star generational feud that always gets phones ringing.*

- A **'70s rock legend** publicly trashed **Taylor Swift**, claiming she **'ruined music'**
- The standout quote: Swift is the **'apotheosis of mediocrity'**
- Comments are already circulating on **Reddit's r/entertainment**, fueling the old-guard-vs-pop-star debate

The Debate Starter

- Old-school rock cred vs. modern pop dominance - who's actually right, and does a decades-old rocker even get a vote anymore?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://parade.com/entertainment/70s-rock-legend-says-taylor-swift-ruined-music-calls-her-the-apotheosis-of-mediocrity

---

■ *Taylor Swift wins Video of the Year at 2026 VMAs*

The Angle: *Taylor Swift just added another trophy to the pile, and it's a fresh reminder that she basically can't lose right now — worth a quick pop-culture check-in even for listeners who don't follow music awards closely.*

- **Taylor Swift** won **Video of the Year** at the **2026 VMAs** for **"The Fate of Ophelia"**
- She was named the **very first recipient** of the **MTV VMA Artist Director Honors**
- It capped what the source calls a **"huge night"** for Swift at the show

The Debate Starter

- Is Taylor Swift's award-season dominance still exciting or has it become predictable at this point?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/video/taylor-swift-wins-video-of-the-year-at-2026-vmas/

■ *Breanna Stewart making WNBA playoff history is no surprise — and gives Liberty reason to dream*

The Angle: *Breanna Stewart put up a stat line in a playoff game that literally has never been recorded before — that's the kind of history that gets even non-basketball fans to pay attention, especially with the Liberty pushing for another title.*

- **Breanna Stewart** dropped **34 points** in Game 1 of the best-of-three series
- She also grabbed **12 rebounds** and dished out **six assists**
- Stewart added **two steals** and **two blocks** — a stat line **never before recorded** in WNBA playoff history
- The performance has the **Liberty** dreaming big as the series continues

The Stat That Stopped Everyone

- A 34-12-6 line with steals and blocks thrown in — is Stewart playing the best playoff basketball we've ever seen?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/27/sports/breanna-stewart-making-playoff-history-gives-liberty-reason-to-dream/

Backup options:

■ *Emmy Rossum Says Her Nude 'Shameless' Scenes Affected Her Dating Life - Variety*

The Angle: *Nine seasons of nude scenes as Fiona Gallagher followed her off-screen — she says guys showed up with assumptions about her before they even said hello. It's a real conversation about how playing a role can warp how people see you in real life.*

- **Emmy Rossum** played **Fiona Gallagher** on **"Shameless"** for all **nine seasons**.
- She says men had **"preconceived notions"** about **"how I was sexually"** based on her nude scenes.
- She's saying the on-screen exposure created real off-screen consequences in her dating life.

The Debate Starter

- Callers: ever had a job or role make people assume they knew you before they actually did?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/emmy-rossum-nude-shameless-scenes-1236876622/

■ *Taylor Swift Premieres ‘Patient Zero’ Music Video at VMAs, Turning Her New ‘Showgirl: Encore’ Single Into a Dramatic Ghost Story*

The Angle: *Taylor Swift used the VMAs stage for the world premiere of her 'Patient Zero' video, and instead of the usual romance visuals, she went full haunted love story — that twist is exactly the kind of thing fans are*

dissecting online right now.

- **Taylor Swift** premiered the **'Patient Zero'** music video live at the **MTV VMAs** Sunday night
- It's the world premiere, dropping right after the single released earlier that same weekend
- The song comes from her **'Showgirl: Encore'** release
- The video reframes the song's love triangle as a full-on **ghost story**

The Debate Starter

- Is this Taylor's best visual twist yet, or is the 'ghost story' angle just a gimmick?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/music/news/taylor-swift-vmas-patient-zero-music-video-premiere-1236876944/

■ *MTV VMAs 2026: See the complete winners list*

The Angle: *The Queen of Pop out-nominated everyone and then went out and proved it, turning her comeback era into the story of the night at pop culture's biggest scoreboard.*

- **Madonna** led the pack with **13 nominations** going into the night
- She walked away with **7 wins** — the most of anyone at the 2026 VMAs
- The ceremony went down at the **Peacock Theater** in **Los Angeles**
- **Taylor Swift** was also in the mix with a heavy nomination haul of her own

The Debate Starter

- Is this a legit career-resurgence moment for Madonna, or did the VMAs just hand out a legacy trophy in a year that was supposed to belong to Taylor?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/video/mtv-vmas-2026-see-the-complete-winners-list/

■ *Candace Cameron Bure, 50, becomes grandma as son Lev welcomes ‘miracle baby’ 10 weeks early*

The Angle: *The 'Full House' alum just became a grandmother after her son's baby arrived 10 weeks early, and there's already a second grandchild on the way — a feel-good family story with a real scare built in.*

- **Candace Cameron Bure**, 50, is officially a grandmother
- Her son **Lev** welcomed what the family is calling a **'miracle baby,' born 10 weeks premature**
- Bure's daughter **Natasha** is also currently pregnant, meaning a second grandchild is on the way
- Bure is best known for playing **D.J. Tanner on 'Full House'**

The Relatable Hook

- A premature birth followed by another grandbaby on the way — ask listeners to call in with their own 'became a grandparent way sooner than expected' stories.

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/27/parents/candace-cameron-bure-50-becomes-grandma-as-son-lev-bure-and-wife-have-first-baby/

TRENDING TODAY

■■ *Shocker: Last Night’s ‘Viral’ Pro-Data Center Party Is Tied to Thiel, the Koch Institute, and Other AI Boosters*

The Angle: *A feel-good, 'grassroots' street party hyping data centers turned out to be backed by Peter Thiel and Koch-network money — a made-for-radio astroturfing story right as data centers become one of the most contentious topics in every neighborhood in America.*

- The party got buzz online as a spontaneous, **grassroots** celebration of a local data center.

- It's actually connected to **Peter Thiel** and the **Koch Institute** — two of the biggest names bankrolling the AI boom.
- Classic **astroturf** move: dress up industry PR as organic neighborhood love to soften public backlash against data centers.

The Debate Starter

- Would you feel duped if your neighborhood's 'community party' turned out to be a billionaire-funded PR stunt?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://gizmodo.com/shocker-last-nights-viral-pro-data-center-party-is-tied-to-thiel-the-koch-institute-and-other-ai-boosters-2000817924

Backup options:

■ *'Mom of the Year' Carries Baby, Food at MLB Game, Defends Husband After Viral Backlash - People.com*

The Angle: *A video of a mom juggling a baby and a food tray at an MLB game blew up online, with commenters slamming her husband for not helping — now she's firing back, and it's tapping into the internet's favorite fight: gender roles in parenting.*

- **A mom went viral** at an **MLB game** for carrying both her baby and a full food tray solo
- Online critics piled on, accusing her husband of not lending a hand
- She's since **defended her husband** publicly, pushing back on the backlash
- The clip has people online arguing over the '**Mom of the Year**' label itself — praise or dig?

The Debate Starter

- Was the internet right to drag the husband, or does this mom owe him an apology for letting it blow up?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirwFBVV95cUxNNVhXYm1aMklpaUtNLTQwektXNWplajM4dGhWdkh4Wm9VT1pqYW55R0NfZVhSSjlUaHBtZFNKTVV3V1hvSXlwdW5jNWMwbkNQSlJ2Z2tCTVZoaEYzMGVNbmhmcGN0aWpfYkE3Y2dvX29VUGFKRlMyZjcwZldLZGFBcGJobDFRY3RQeHcyYTJrN25RVExFUUZzYkxMTmdUa2E3Y0hYeDduSWVhMlFsNHFV?oc=5

■ *'We are not having much fun anymore': Delayed harvest pushes farmers to the breaking point*

The Angle: *It's harvest season and farmers are burned out — weather delays are stretching an already brutal work stretch even longer, and that stress trickles down to food supply and prices everyone feels at the grocery store.*

- One farmer's blunt quote sums up the mood: **'We are not having much fun anymore.'**
- The delayed harvest is reportedly pushing farmers to **the breaking point** this season.

The Empathy Check

- Anyone in our audience connected to farming — is this the toughest harvest stretch you can remember?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMivgFBVV95cUxQOGRrdkQ4elNVZml6aHU3bkYxYWpScTUtYVFWYllCazJUNW9OOFFaSlZpZlNJQXJCVXVZa1NiemZ4TU1KeFFUT3FLdG0xTGREUmV4V2JiR1c5em11Rmc5RDRZb19ndzduQnhlbml6b3hZVUpncTFfbW1JLWhnN0JqOTB0VUI4UzNjSzhhZ3RnRkZxY2NIc1dBeVE3UndOVjI2aW93TlRzdU5CdTNTbnp1bVozdldvTTg2WFVzVUJB?oc=5

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *How companies use digital dark patterns to trick online consumers into handed-over personal tracking data for behavioral advertising. 86% of the websites audited used deceptive visual configurations on their cookies and privacy ad banners to manipulate choice.*

The Angle: *Everyone clicks 'accept' on those cookie pop-ups just to make them go away — turns out that's exactly the point. A new study says the vast majority of sites are engineering those boxes to manipulate your choice, not really give you one.*

- Researchers audited websites' cookie and privacy banners for **'dark patterns'** — sneaky design tricks meant to steer your click.
- **86%** of the sites audited used deceptive visual setups, like burying 'reject' behind extra clicks while 'accept' is one big obvious button.
- The goal: harvest your personal browsing data for **behavioral advertising** — the ads that follow you around the internet.

The Confession Booth

- Be honest — do you actually read those cookie pop-ups, or just smash 'accept' to make it disappear?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1144097

Backup options:

■ *Texas parents sue nursery over alleged 'child fight club'*

The Angle: *This is the kind of headline that stops you mid-scroll — a lawsuit claiming a nursery let toddlers get pitted against each other is pure jaw-drop, watercooler material, and it taps straight into every parent's worst 'can I actually trust daycare' fear.*

The Trust Test

- Would a story like this make you pull your kid out of daycare on the spot, or wait for the facts?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://iclg.com/news/texas-parents-sue-nursery-over-alleged-child-fight-club/

■ *Flock seeks to have security researchers' map of Flock cameras taken down — Unauthenticated flaw exposed 335,701 camera locations nationwide*

The Angle: *A security flaw let anyone see the exact locations of over 335,000 license-plate-reading cameras across the country, and now the company wants the map that exposed it taken down instead of just saying thanks for the heads up.*

- Security researchers built a map exposing **335,701 Flock camera locations** nationwide.
- The flaw was reportedly **unauthenticated** — no login or hacking skill needed to find it.
- **Flock** is now pushing to get the researchers' map taken down rather than addressing it head-on.
- Flock cameras are used widely by police departments and HOAs for license plate tracking.

The Debate Starter

- Should a company be able to bury the messenger who just proved your surveillance cameras aren't even secure?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/cyber-security/flock-seeks-to-have-security-researchers-map-of-flock-cameras-taken-down-unauthenticated-flaw-exposed-335-701-camera-locations-nationwide

---

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *New Mexico jury finds Facebook liable for over 43 million violations of consumer protection law—and Meta could owe over $200 billion in penalties*

The Angle: *New Mexico jury finds Facebook liable for over 43 million violations of consumer protection law—and Meta could owe over $200 billion in penalties*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://fortune.com/2026/09/26/facebook-liable-violations-new-mexico-consumer-protection-lawand-meta-200-billion-penalties/

Backup options:

■ *'Like a zombie': Woman recalls moment she had a chunk of her forehead bitten off by stranger*

The Angle: *This is peak 'r/nottheonion' - a woman says a random attacker went full zombie-movie on her, and the sheer 'wait, WHAT?' factor of that headline is exactly what makes for a great last-story-before-the-goodbye.*

- Victim says a **stranger** bit a **chunk of her forehead** off during the attack
- She describes the attacker as acting **'like a zombie'** in the moment
- Story is circulating out of the **r/nottheonion** community, tagged as almost-too-weird-to-be-real news

The 'Wait, What?' Reaction

- Give us your most 'that can't be real' reaction to the word 'zombie' being used in an actual police-style story.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kgns.tv/2026/09/25/like-zombie-woman-recalls-moment-she-had-chunk-her-forehead-bitten-off-by-stranger/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *After 30 years of work, the Yellowstone to Yukon Conservation Initiative has helped protect roughly 25 million hectares and built more than 200 wildlife crossings, cutting wildlife vehicle collisions by 96% on parts of Banff's Highway 1. It is now an Earthshot Prize finalist.*

The Angle: *It's a genuinely feel-good win in a news cycle full of gloom — a decades-long conservation project actually worked, and it's now a finalist for one of the biggest environmental prizes on the planet.*

- **Yellowstone to Yukon Conservation Initiative** has been running for **30 years**
- Helped protect roughly **25 million hectares** of land
- Built more than **200 wildlife crossings** across the region
- Cut wildlife-vehicle collisions by **96%** on parts of **Banff's Highway 1**

The Feel-Good Fact

- Have you ever had a close call swerving for an animal on the highway — because this project says there's a fix that actually works.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://y2y.net/blog/y2y-2026-earthshot-prize-finalist/

■ *Hungary to impose wealth tax on the richest people starting next year*

The Angle: *Wealth taxes on the ultra-rich are one of the biggest economic debates going right now, and Hungary just became the latest country to actually pull the trigger instead of just talking about it - that's a real-world test case for a policy North American politicians keep floating too.*

- **Hungary** is moving forward with a new **wealth tax** aimed at its richest residents.
- The tax is set to kick in **starting next year**.

- It puts Hungary among a small handful of countries willing to directly tax the ultra-wealthy rather than just debate it.

The Debate Starter

- Should the ultra-rich here get taxed the same way - or would that just send them packing?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://aroundprague.cz/en/news/hungary-to-impose-wealth-tax-on-the-richest-people-starting-next-year

---

■ *Belgium's laughing gas problem is no joke*

The Angle: *What started as a rave-culture party trick sold in colorful canisters has snowballed into a real public health and environmental headache for Belgium — even the waste plants can't handle it.*

- Nitrous oxide is now one of **Belgium's** most visible drugs, sold cheap and marketed like a party accessory
- It's deeply tied to **rave culture** in the country
- Disposal has gotten so bad it's literally caused **waste plants to explode**
- **Brussels** is now struggling just to contain the fallout

The Debate Starter

- A balloon full of gas blowing up a waste plant — is this the dumbest drug crisis you've ever heard of, or just the next vape?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.brusselstimes.com/belgium/2333294/belgiums-laughing-gas-problem-is-no-joke

---

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Amazon is expanding Prime refunds, with eligible customers able to receive up to $200 automatically.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Actionable 'check if you're owed up to $200' personal-finance hook spreads through direct shares, not just passive reads.
The Angle: *Amazon's Prime settlement with the FTC just got a lot bigger, and millions more customers are now eligible for automatic refunds - no forms, no fighting customer service, just free money showing up.*

- Part of Amazon's **$2.5 billion settlement** with the **FTC** over allegations it made Prime hard to cancel
- Max payout jumps from **$51** to **$200** per eligible customer
- Anyone who used **11 to 20 Prime benefits** in a one-year stretch now qualifies
- Amazon's already paid out **$845.2 million** in refunds as of **September 9, 2026**

The Phone-In Trigger

- Check your email right now - anyone listening already gotten one of these Amazon refund notices?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2026/09/ftc-announces-additional-payments-consumers-stemming-ftcs-amazon-prime-settlement

---

■■ *Rolls-Royce 470 MW nuclear reactors lock in critical safety hardware*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Rolls-Royce's name plus the current AI-data-center power crunch narrative gives this nuclear story unusually strong trend alignment right now.
The Angle: *Small modular reactors are the nuclear industry's big comeback play right now, especially with AI data centers guzzling power - and Rolls-Royce just hit a major safety milestone on theirs.*

- **Rolls-Royce** has finalized critical safety hardware for its **470 MW** small modular reactor design

- The move is a key step toward getting these mini reactors licensed and built
- Small modular reactors are being pitched as a faster, cheaper alternative to traditional nuclear plants

The Debate Starter

- Nuclear's having a moment again - would you be fine with a mini reactor built near your town if it meant cheaper, cleaner power?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://interestingengineering.com/energy/rolls-royce-470-mw-nuclear-reactors-safety

---

■ *Popular AI models use arbitrary facial features to predict criminality and job performance*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The 'AI phrenology' angle - facial features predicting criminality - is a novel, alarming hook that taps directly into the growing AI-distrust news cycle.

The Angle: *New research says popular AI models are scanning faces to guess who's a criminal or a good employee, reviving 19th-century pseudoscience with 21st-century tech - and it's a live wire because these tools are already creeping into hiring and policing.*

- Researchers found **popular AI models** making predictions about **criminality** from facial features alone
- The same models were also used to guess **job performance** based on someone's face
- Critics say this echoes **phrenology** - the debunked practice of judging character by head/face shape
- Raises fresh alarm about **bias baked into AI** used in hiring and law enforcement tools

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust an AI's read on your face over an actual human interview?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/popular-ai-models-use-arbitrary-facial-features-to-predict-criminality-and-job-performance/

■ *Anthony Mackie Says Chris Evans Gave Him the ‘Avengers: Endgame’ Script Early, Revealing How He’d Become Captain America: ‘It Was Really Great and Really Emotional’*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Big MCU names (Mackie, Evans) plus an emotional behind-the-scenes nostalgia beat is exactly the kind of story the massive Marvel fanbase reshares.

The Angle: *A juicy behind-the-scenes MCU story that fans still obsess over — the passing of the shield from Chris Evans to Anthony Mackie in Endgame, straight from Mackie himself.*

- **Anthony Mackie** says **Chris Evans** gave him the **'Avengers: Endgame'** script early
- That early read revealed Mackie's character would become **Captain America**
- Mackie called the moment **'really great and really emotional'**

The Fan Nostalgia Bit

- What's the MCU moment that hit YOU right in the feels?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/chris-evans-anthony-mackie-avengers-endgame-script-early-1236876896/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 5 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 20 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)
- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in ‘Damn Yankees’ Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)

Newly banked this run:
- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in ‘Damn Yankees’ Broadway Revival"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 3 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-27 11:43 PM